Basic Excel Questions

1. **What are the different data formats available in Excel?**
   Answer: Excel supports General, Number, Currency, Accounting, Date, Time, Percentage, Fraction, Scientific, Text, and Custom formats.
2. **What is the difference between a workbook and a worksheet?**
   Answer: A workbook is an Excel file containing multiple worksheets (sheets). A worksheet is a single spreadsheet inside a workbook.
3. **How do you remove duplicates in Excel?**
   Answer: Use Data → Remove Duplicates and select the columns to check for duplicates.
4. **How do you apply filters in Excel?**
   Answer: Select your dataset and go to Data → Filter to enable filters for each column.
5. **What is the shortcut to quickly select an entire column or row?**
   Answer:
   - Entire column: Ctrl + Space
   - Entire row: Shift + Space

Formulas and Functions

6. **What is the difference between COUNT, COUNTA, COUNTIF, and COUNTIFS?**
   Answer:
   - COUNT counts numeric values.
   - COUNTA counts non-empty cells.
   - COUNTIF counts based on a single condition.
   - COUNTIFS counts based on multiple conditions.
7. **What does the VLOOKUP function do?**
   Answer: It searches for a value in the first column of a range and returns a corresponding value from another column in the same row.
8. **What is the syntax of VLOOKUP?**
   Answer: =VLOOKUP(lookup_value, table_array, col_index_num, [range_lookup])
9. **What is HLOOKUP?**
   Answer: It is similar to VLOOKUP but searches in the first row of a table instead of the first column.
10. **What is INDEX-MATCH, and why is it better than VLOOKUP?**
    Answer: INDEX-MATCH is a combination of two functions:
    - INDEX returns the value of a cell based on row and column numbers.
    - MATCH finds the position of a value in a range.
      It is better than VLOOKUP because it allows searching in any column, not just the first one, and is more efficient.

Advanced Excel Questions

11. **What is Power Query in Excel?**
    Answer: Power Query is a tool to connect, transform, and combine data from different sources.
12. **What is Power Pivot?**
    Answer: Power Pivot allows working with large datasets, creating data models, and performing complex calculations.
13. **How do you create a Pivot Table?**
    Answer:
    - Select data range
    - Go to Insert → PivotTable
    - Choose data source and destination
    - Drag fields into the PivotTable fields area
14. **How do you refresh a Pivot Table automatically?**
    Answer: Use VBA or enable "Refresh data when opening file" in PivotTable Options.
15. **What is a slicer in Pivot Tables?**
    Answer: A slicer is a visual filter for PivotTables, allowing users to filter data easily.
16. **What is a Data Model in Excel?**
    Answer: A Data Model allows creating relationships between different tables without using VLOOKUP.
17. **How do you use conditional formatting in Excel?**
    Answer: Select cells → Home → Conditional Formatting → Apply rules like color scales, icon sets, or formulas.
18. **What is a dynamic named range?**
    Answer: A range that expands automatically as new data is added, using formulas like OFFSET or INDEX.
19. **What are array formulas?**
    Answer: Formulas that perform multiple calculations at once and return multiple values.
20. **What is the difference between absolute, relative, and mixed cell references?**
    Answer:
    - Absolute (A1): Fixed cell reference.
    - Relative (A1): Changes when copied.
    - Mixed ($A1 or A$1): Partially fixed reference.

Excel Charts and Data Visualization

21. **How do you create a dynamic chart in Excel?**
    Answer: Use dynamic named ranges or tables.
22. **What is a combo chart?**
    Answer: A combination of two chart types (e.g., bar and line chart) for better data visualization.
23. **How do you add a secondary axis in Excel?**
    Answer: Select the series → Format Data Series → Enable Secondary Axis.
24. **What is a waterfall chart?**
    Answer: A chart that shows cumulative values with positive and negative changes.
25. **How do you create a dashboard in Excel?**
    Answer: Use PivotTables, charts, slicers, and conditional formatting to visualize data.

Scenario-Based Questions

26 **How would you find the top 10 sales in a dataset?**
Answer: Use LARGE(array, k) function or sort data and filter the top 10.

27 **How do you highlight duplicates in Excel?**
Answer: Use Conditional Formatting → Highlight Duplicate Values.

28 **How do you remove blank rows in Excel?**
Answer: Filter blank cells and delete them manually or use VBA.

29 **How do you consolidate data from multiple sheets?**
Answer: Use Power Query, Consolidate feature, or VBA.

30 **How do you extract the first word from a text string?**
Answer: =LEFT(A1, FIND(" ", A1)-1)